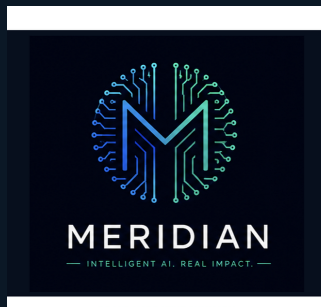




Export Anatolia

Full Seven-Manager AI Adoption Briefing

Complete Meridian analysis across all seven intelligence domains

Prepared for discussion with Yuksel Kangal

PRIVATE AND CONFIDENTIAL -- BUSINESS ONLY

WHY THIS BRIEFING EXISTS

Yuksel is, understandably, reticent about AI. That reticence is worth taking seriously rather than arguing past — most AI adoption conversations fail because they open with the technology instead of the business problem. This briefing is built the other way round: it starts from Export Anatolia's real, verified operations, and only then asks where AI actually pays for itself, where it doesn't, and where it introduces risk that isn't worth taking. Nothing here recommends AI for its own sake. Several sections actively recommend not adopting it yet, or only in a narrow, low-risk pilot.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Export Anatolia (legal name **Anatolya Otomotiv Traktor Yedek Parca Ithalat Ihracat Ticaret A.S.**), founded **2001** by Yuksel Kangal and headquartered in Menemen, Izmir, is a genuine, substantial manufacturer and exporter of spare parts for agricultural tractors, combine harvesters and mowing equipment, trading through two named subsidiaries: **ARIMIS Seating** and **SDM** (sheet metal components). Company-reported scale: approximately 300 employees across the group, a roughly 7,500 square metre export facility, around 500 x 40-foot containers shipped annually, 98 percent export-focused, ISO 9001:2015 certified, running SAP Business One as its ERP, with a reported 96.7 percent order fulfilment rate and under 0.003 percent returns.

That last set of facts matters more than it might look. A company already running ISO 9001:2015, SAP Business One, and tracking fulfilment and returns to three decimal places is not starting from zero on data and process discipline — it already has the operational bones that make targeted AI adoption low-risk rather than speculative. The case for AI here is not “modernise a paper-based business.” It is “you already measure what matters; a small number of AI applications sit directly on top of data you already collect.”

One correction carried forward: an earlier profile described a castings and foundry business. That was wrong. This briefing, and the company's own note, confirm the real product lines: tractor, combine and mower spare parts, seating, and sheet metal.

Manager 1 -- Commercial and Market Intelligence

Turkey's real position in agricultural machinery

Turkey's domestic tractor market was valued at approximately USD 1.6 billion in 2024, and Turkey imported over a billion dollars of tractors that same year (52,180 units) — a major market on both the import and export side simultaneously. Domestic manufacturers include Erkunt Traktor Sanayii, TurkTraktor, Uzel and Hattat Holding, alongside assembly presence from CNH Industrial, AGCO and John Deere. Turkish-made tractors are price-competitive against European manufacture, with real export traction in the 50-90 horsepower segment.

Company-reported operational strength (new, from Export Anatolia's own note)

ISO 9001:2015 certification, SAP Business One as ERP, 96.7 percent order fulfilment, under 0.003 percent returns. Strong figures if accurate, and directly relevant to the AI discussion — a business with this level of data discipline already has the substrate most companies have to build before AI adds value.

Primary markets: US and UK, with 98 percent of production exported — a genuinely diversified, internationally credible customer base for a company of this size.

Manager 2 -- Legal, Trade and Regulatory Intelligence

The Customs Union advantage is real and current

The EU-Turkey Customs Union (Association Council Decision 1/95) covers industrial goods including tractor spare parts, seating and sheet metal — tariff-free, quota-free movement into the EU and Ireland. Does not remove product-safety or conformity requirements, which sit separately.

The compliance framework that actually applies

- **Machinery Regulation (EU) 2023/1230** (in force January 2027) governs machinery, safety components, and parts placed on the EU market.
- **Agricultural and forestry tractors and tractor-specific components fall under the separate Tractor Type-Approval Regulation (EU) No 167/2013.**
- **Tractor seats (ARIMIS Seating) sit in a well-established, EU-harmonised type-approval regime** under Regulation 167/2013 — the area of highest genuine regulatory exposure in the group.
- **Sheet metal (SDM)** falls under the Machinery Regulation's safety-component provisions only if structural/safety-relevant.

The EU AI Act -- the honest, reticence-relevant answer

With no AI system currently in use, Export Anatolia has **low to no current exposure** under Regulation (EU) 2024/1689. This is the single most important fact for a reticent owner to hear: adopting AI does not automatically drag the company into a heavy compliance regime. Real exposure only arises with specific higher-risk applications the recommendations below deliberately avoid.

Turkish domestic law: KVKK (Law No. 6698) applies to any AI system processing personal data. Turkey's National AI Strategy (2021-2025) is policy guidance, not binding law. Proportionate governance recommendation: no compliance programme is warranted now — a short AI use register only if and when a specific system is adopted.

Manager 3 -- AI Strategy and Adoption (the core of this briefing)

Addressing the reticence directly -- what AI is not, here

- Not a wholesale replacement of the 300-person operation or the engineering judgement that built a 25-year export business.
- Not a mandatory compliance burden — AI Act exposure is genuinely low unless Export Anatolia chooses higher-risk applications, and it doesn't need to.
- Not all-or-nothing — every application below can be piloted on one line or process before wider rollout, and dropped if it doesn't pay.
- Not proprietary technology risk — the strongest-fit applications are bolt-on, commercially available tools layered onto data already collected through SAP Business One, not bespoke builds.

Ranked by genuine fit and payback

- 1. AI-powered visual quality inspection (highest, most proven fit).** Mature, commercially available technology for metal component manufacturing — catching surface defects, dimensional inconsistencies and material flaws faster and more consistently than manual inspection. Directly complementary to an already-strong 96.7% fulfilment / under-0.003%-returns record: this protects and extends the exact reputation the business already competes on.
- 2. Precision-agriculture component opportunity (highest strategic upside, medium term).** As global tractor manufacturers make precision agriculture standard, component manufacturers face a real choice: stay commodity, or embed sensing and connectivity into components already being manufactured (frames, hitches, drawbars, sensor-enabled seating). Named real partners already active here: HBK, Hexagon's precision-agriculture portfolio, Sensor Solutions Corp. Best approached as a partnership, not in-house development from scratch.
- 3. Export operations -- demand forecasting and logistics/quoting.** Well-proven, low-risk, typically available as modules within SAP Business One rather than bespoke development — the lowest-friction starting point of all.
- 4. Energy and sustainability, if the solar/rainwater claims are confirmed as material.** If material, AI-driven solar generation forecasting paired with production scheduling is a genuinely strong fit, and strengthens the commercial sustainability case with European buyers.

What Meridian does not recommend: no closed-loop autonomous production AI, no broad "AI transformation" programme, no AI adoption for its own sake in HR/admin functions where payback is unproven at this scale. A proportionate first step: a pilot AI-assisted quality inspection system on one line, measured against the fulfilment/returns benchmarks Export Anatolia already tracks. If it doesn't measurably beat those benchmarks, it doesn't get rolled out further.

Manager 4 -- Finance, Trade and Currency Intelligence

The Turkish Central Bank has held its policy rate at 37 percent through mid-2026 in a deliberate disinflation strategy, with the lira on a managed depreciation path. Because Export Anatolia's costs are largely lira-denominated while export revenue is earned in hard currency, sustained depreciation structurally compresses the cost base relative to the export price list — a genuine, structural competitiveness advantage.

Turk Eximbank is the natural financing partner: Turkey's official export credit agency delivered USD 54.3 billion in support in 2025, with 83 percent of the roughly 18,500 exporters it supports being SMEs, precisely Export Anatolia's profile.

The EU's Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive requires large in-scope companies to report Scope 3 (supply-chain) emissions. Export Anatolia's larger European buyers increasingly need supplier-level sustainability data. Given the company's own note now states renewable generation and rainwater harvesting are in operation, a simple standing supplier sustainability fact sheet is low-cost to produce and

directly answers what CSRD-affected buyers are asking for — a case where a modest AI application (forecasting/scheduling) and a commercial opportunity reinforce each other.

The honest funding picture: this reads as a strong candidate for debt-led growth capital — Eximbank export-investment credit or green/energy-linked facilities — rather than an equity venture story.

Manager 5 -- Property and Development

Export Anatolia operates from a company-reported 7,500 square metre export facility in Menemen, Izmir — an established industrial zone with good logistics access for container export. No public information indicates recent expansion, relocation or new-build activity; this is a stable, established base, not a growth-stage property story.

A fixed, established facility of this scale is a point in favour of the quality-inspection pilot: it is a bounded, known production environment, well suited to installing and measuring a single-line AI trial. If the solar generation claim is confirmed as installed on-site, a direct site-level confirmation of installed capacity unlocks both the sustainability commercial story and the energy-scheduling AI application. No property-related red flags identified.

Manager 6 -- Business Transformation and Growth

The real transformation question is not technology, it is sequencing and ownership. For a reticent owner, the most common reason a pilot AI project fails is unclear ownership and no defined success measure. Export Anatolia's existing operational discipline means the transformation task is to extend that same discipline to one AI pilot, not introduce a new way of working.

Recommended sequencing, deliberately narrow

1. Pick one line, one process, one AI application — the quality-inspection pilot is the strongest candidate because it sits directly on an existing, already-measured KPI (returns rate).
2. Name one internal owner for the pilot — someone who already owns quality or production data today, not a new hire and not an external consultant running the show.
3. Set the success measure before starting, using the existing benchmark (under 0.003% returns) as the bar the AI system has to clear or beat.
4. Run it in parallel with the existing manual process for a defined trial window, so nothing is put at risk while the tool is tested.
5. Decide to expand, adjust or drop based on the measured result, not on enthusiasm either way.

The biggest real risk in AI adoption for a business like this is not the technology failing — it is a rushed, broad rollout disrupting a well-functioning operation for a benefit that hasn't been proven yet. This sequencing is designed specifically to avoid that: small, measured, reversible, owned internally.

Manager 7 -- AI Equity and Investment

Not applicable as an investment case. This briefing is not an investment proposition — Export Anatolia is not raising external capital in this conversation, and nothing here should be read as recommending equity investment activity. Any capital need is better met through debt-led, export-credit financing (Eximbank) than equity.

None of the AI applications recommended require external AI-specific investment capital. The quality-inspection pilot and ERP-based forecasting/logistics tools are commercially available, proportionately priced technology purchases. The precision-agriculture component opportunity is a partnership and product-development play, not a capital raise. This keeps the AI conversation with Yuksel entirely inside his own decision-making, without introducing outside investors into a discussion that doesn't need them.

Overall Assessment

Export Anatolia is a substantial, well-run manufacturing exporter with real operational discipline already in place, a structural currency advantage, a specific and manageable EU regulatory position, and a stable, established production base. None of that changes because of AI — the point of this briefing is that AI is not a precondition for any of Export Anatolia's existing strengths, and adopting it narrowly and carefully can extend two of those strengths (quality reputation, export-market positioning) without the broad risk, cost or compliance burden that reticence about AI usually assumes comes with it.

The single most useful thing to say to Yuksel directly: the honest, evidence-based case for AI at Export Anatolia is narrow, not broad — one quality-inspection pilot on one line, measured against numbers he already tracks, with a clear stop/go decision at the end of a defined trial. That is a very different, much smaller commitment than “adopting AI,” and it is the version most likely to be worth his time.

Meridian Intelligence · Export Anatolia full seven-manager strategic briefing · Verified analysis across Commercial, Legal, AI Strategy, Finance, Property, Business Transformation and Investment · 31 July 2026 · Private and confidential, business-only scope.